The CareLeaders Learning

Course brochure

NVR and relationships

NVR Essentials

One day. A full framework.

A one-day introduction to non-violent resistance for residential and fostering teams. No prior NVR knowledge needed. Your staff leave with the framework, a pack to run a session with their own team, and 12 months' access to the NVR Toolkit online.



Length
One day

How
Face to face

Group
Up to 20 people

For
Residential and family support and more

The problem it solves

When a young person's behaviour escalates, staff often fall back on instinct, and each shift responds differently. Services need one shared way to respond to violence, aggression and coercion that keeps adults safe and the relationship intact.

Helps with

- Behaviour, incidents and restraint
- Stability and matching



What changes

What is different after the course.

For your staff

- Use one framework and one language for violence, aggression and coercion
- Handle the hot moment with a protocol rather than instinct
- Make reconciliation gestures routine rather than forgotten
- Run a first NVR session with their own team within a month

For children

- Adults who stay calm and present when things escalate
- The same response from every adult, whoever is on shift
- Repair after a hard moment, so the relationship is not left broken
- Adults who resist the behaviour, never the child

What they learn

The knowledge and the tools.

- What NVR is and why it works
- The seven pillars, and the three dimensions of presence
- De-escalation: cold-iron lines, baskets and the hot-moment protocol
- Reconciliation gestures and acts of resistance
- How to run a first NVR session with their own team

Who it is for

- Residential managers and staff in children's homes
- Fostering team leaders, supervising social workers and foster carers
- Early help and family workers coaching parents
- Commissioners deciding whether NVR is right for their service

Session by session

How the course runs.

Story Theory Action

1 The NVR stance

Morning. What non-violent resistance is, where it comes from, and the framework on one page: connection before correction, parental presence and the seven pillars, with the evidence and how NVR fits Ofsted expectations.

You leave with The NVR framework on one page, with the seven pillars

2 De-escalation

Morning. Strike when the iron is cold. Short lines, baskets and delayed responses, practised on the situations your staff actually face.

You leave with Cold-iron lines, baskets and the hot-moment protocol, practised

3 Reconciliation and resistance

Afternoon. Resist the behaviour, never the child. Reconciliation gestures and acts of resistance at three levels, worked through on real residential and fostering scenarios.

You leave with Reconciliation gesture menus and acts of resistance for your setting

4 Leading it in your team

Afternoon. How to run an NVR session with your own team, and a plan for the first one back at work.

You leave with A plan for your first NVR session with your team

Choose how you run it

Formats.

Face to face

We come to you: development days, twilights and team days, in your building or a venue you choose.

Length	One full day, 10am to 3:30pm
Group	Up to 20 people
You provide	A room, a screen and the time protected

Included: 12 months' access to the NVR Toolkit online, plus slide decks, a facilitator guide, scripts and templates to take home

Delivered NVR training for Durham County Council's children's homes reached 120 residential staff across 11 homes.

Does NVR fit what Ofsted expects?

The morning covers the evidence for NVR and how it fits Ofsted expectations, so managers can explain why their service is using it.

Is it for fostering as well as children's homes?

Yes. It is for residential managers and staff, fostering team leaders, supervising social workers, foster carers, and early help workers coaching parents. Scenarios come from residential and fostering settings.

Do we need any NVR knowledge first?

No. NVR Essentials starts from the beginning.

How many people can attend?

Up to 20, so everyone practises.

What is the NVR Toolkit?

Our online NVR course on The Care Leaders Online: foundations, parental presence and the seven pillars, with a video, reading and an activity for each. Participants get 12 months' access.

What happens after the day?

Participants run a first session with their own team. Those who will lead NVR in your service can go on to NVR Advanced.

Can it be online?

The day works best face to face. Ask us about a live online version for a dispersed team.

Can you shape it around our service?

Yes. We tailor the examples, the length and the mix of people in the room to your service, your procedures and the children you work with.



Luke Rodgers BEM
Founder and CEO, The Care Leaders

Who designs and delivers it

From care leaver to care leader.

Luke went into care at 10. At 15 he was living in a bed and breakfast, and at 18 in a caravan. He gave his first keynote at 19, and has spent his career since inside children's services as a consultant, trainer, speaker and national engagement lead.

He set up The Care Leaders to go from care leaver to care leader, and to help others make the same move. He led the national engagement on England's new fostering standards, was a Knowledge Equity Fellow at Saïd Business School, University of Oxford, and was awarded the British Empire Medal in 2018.

Every course is designed by Luke and follows the same Story, Theory, Action approach. It is delivered by people with lived experience of care and professional experience of children's services.

- **Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award**
  iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026
- **British Empire Medal**
  2018, for commitment to children and families
- **Knowledge Equity Fellow**
  Saïd Business School, University of Oxford
- **45+ keynotes since 2024**
  From team days to national conferences

The CareLeaders Learning

Getting started

Bring NVR Essentials to your team.

1 Get in touch
Tell us who it is for and roughly how many people.

2 Have a call
We talk through your service, your people and your dates.

3 Get a clear quote
We quote per cohort, based on numbers, format and how much tailoring you want.

4 We run it
Shaped around your service, your procedures and the children you work with.

hello@thecareleaders.com · 0800 233 5597

Often booked with

NVR and relationships
NVR Advanced
For the people who will lead NVR in your service: coaching colleagues and training teams.

Understanding care
Behind the Behaviour
Reading behaviour as communication, and responding without losing the relationship.

NVR and relationships
Care Not Custody
Reducing the criminalisation of children in care, for children's homes, police and youth justice.

iese Awards GOLD Winner 2026 The Public Sector Transformation Awards

Children & Young People Now Awards 2023 Winner

Gold, Dual Perspective Leadership Award, iESE Public Sector Transformation Awards 2026.
Children & Young People Now Workforce Development Award 2023.